SCHOOL OF BUSINESS STUDIES

BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION & MANAGEMENT

Complete 50-Page Course Module

Beginner → Intermediate

Management • Entrepreneurship • Marketing • Human Resources • Operations • Finance • Strategy

A structured course covering management principles, entrepreneurship, strategic management, marketing, human resources, operations, finance, governance, risk, digital business, project management, and professional ethics.

Course Overview

Purpose: This module provides a broad foundation in Business Administration and Management for School of Business Studies learners.

Learning outcomes: Learners should be able to explain management functions, analyze business environments, develop basic business plans, understand marketing and HR processes, manage operations, interpret financial information, evaluate risks, and apply professional and ethical principles.

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Lesson 1: Introduction to Business Administration

Lesson Content

Business administration coordinates people, resources, processes, information, and finances to achieve organizational objectives efficiently and effectively. It covers planning, organizing, staffing, directing, controlling, and decision-making.

Exercise

Define business administration and state five functions of management.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 2: Nature and Scope of Management

Lesson Content

Management is the process of planning, organizing, staffing, directing, coordinating, and controlling resources to achieve objectives. Managers operate at different organizational levels and across many functional areas.

Exercise

Differentiate top, middle, and first-line management.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 3: Management Functions

Lesson Content

The core functions are planning, organizing, staffing, directing or leading, and controlling. Coordination and decision-making support all of these functions.

Exercise

Explain the five major management functions.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 4: Business Environment

Lesson Content

Organizations operate within internal and external environments. Economic, technological, political, legal, social, competitive, and ecological factors can affect business performance.

Exercise

List six external business-environment factors.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 5: Forms of Business Ownership

Lesson Content

Common forms include sole proprietorships, partnerships, companies, cooperatives, and other legally recognized structures. Each has different ownership, liability, financing, and governance characteristics.

Exercise

Compare sole proprietorship, partnership, and company ownership.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 6: Entrepreneurship

Lesson Content

Entrepreneurship involves identifying opportunities, organizing resources, accepting calculated risk, innovating, and creating value through a venture or initiative.

Exercise

List six characteristics of successful entrepreneurs.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 7: Business Ideas and Opportunity Analysis

Lesson Content

A viable opportunity addresses a real need and has a feasible value proposition, target market, resource plan, and sustainable economics. Opportunity analysis tests assumptions before significant investment.

Exercise

Explain five factors used to evaluate a business opportunity.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 8: Business Planning

Lesson Content

A business plan communicates the venture's objectives, market, operations, marketing strategy, management structure, financial expectations, risks, and implementation approach.

Exercise

List the major sections of a business plan.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 9: Organizational Structure

Lesson Content

Organizational structure defines roles, authority, reporting relationships, communication channels, and coordination mechanisms. Common structures include functional, divisional, matrix, and team-based forms.

Exercise

Differentiate functional and divisional structures.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 10: Organizational Culture

Lesson Content

Culture consists of shared values, beliefs, norms, and practices that influence how people behave and make decisions. Strong cultures should support ethical and effective performance.

Exercise

What is organizational culture?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 11: Leadership Fundamentals

Lesson Content

Leadership involves influencing and enabling people toward shared objectives. Effective leadership requires communication, judgment, emotional awareness, accountability, and adaptability.

Exercise

Differentiate leadership from management.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 12: Leadership Styles

Lesson Content

Leadership styles include autocratic, democratic, participative, coaching, transformational, transactional, and situational approaches. The appropriate style depends on context and people.

Exercise

Compare two leadership styles.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 13: Motivation

Lesson Content

Motivation explains why individuals direct effort toward goals. Managers can use meaningful work, recognition, development, fair rewards, autonomy, and supportive conditions to improve engagement.

Exercise

List five non-financial motivators.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 14: Team Building

Lesson Content

Effective teams require clear objectives, complementary skills, trust, communication, defined roles, accountability, and constructive conflict management.

Exercise

List seven characteristics of effective teams.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 15: Communication in Organizations

Lesson Content

Organizational communication includes downward, upward, horizontal, formal, informal, verbal, written, and digital communication. Good communication should be clear, timely, accurate, and appropriate to the audience.

Exercise

List five barriers to effective communication.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 16: Business Meetings

Lesson Content

Well-run meetings have clear objectives, agendas, appropriate participants, time management, documented decisions, and assigned actions.

Exercise

State seven rules for effective meetings.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 17: Decision-Making

Lesson Content

Managers make programmed and non-programmed decisions using information, analysis, experience, judgment, and risk assessment. A structured decision process improves consistency.

Exercise

Outline a seven-step decision-making process.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 18: Problem Solving

Lesson Content

Problem solving identifies the gap between current and desired conditions, investigates root causes, develops alternatives, selects an appropriate response, and verifies results.

Exercise

Differentiate a symptom from a root cause.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 19: Strategic Management

Lesson Content

Strategic management aligns organizational purpose, resources, capabilities, and competitive positioning with long-term objectives. Strategy requires analysis, implementation, monitoring, and adaptation.

Exercise

What is strategic management?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 20: Vision, Mission and Objectives

Lesson Content

A vision describes an intended future state, a mission explains organizational purpose, and objectives translate direction into measurable targets.

Exercise

Differentiate vision, mission, and objectives.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 21: SWOT Analysis

Lesson Content

SWOT examines internal strengths and weaknesses and external opportunities and threats. It supports strategic diagnosis when used with evidence and appropriate market analysis.

Exercise

Perform a SWOT analysis for a small business.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 22: PESTLE Analysis

Lesson Content

PESTLE examines political, economic, social, technological, legal, and environmental factors that may affect an organization or market.

Exercise

List the six PESTLE factors.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 23: Marketing Fundamentals

Lesson Content

Marketing identifies customer needs, creates value, communicates offerings, and builds relationships. It includes market research, segmentation, positioning, product, pricing, promotion, and distribution.

Exercise

Define marketing and distinguish it from selling.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 24: Market Research

Lesson Content

Market research gathers and analyzes information about customers, competitors, demand, trends, and market conditions. Primary research collects new data; secondary research uses existing sources.

Exercise

Differentiate primary and secondary research.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 25: Market Segmentation and Targeting

Lesson Content

Segmentation divides a market into meaningful groups based on characteristics such as demographics, geography, behavior, or needs. Targeting selects segments the organization can serve effectively.

Exercise

Name four common bases of market segmentation.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 26: Marketing Mix

Lesson Content

The traditional marketing mix uses Product, Price, Place, and Promotion. Services marketing often expands this framework to include People, Process, and Physical Evidence.

Exercise

Explain the 4Ps of marketing.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 27: Branding and Customer Value

Lesson Content

A brand represents an organization's identity and the associations customers make with its offering. Customer value reflects perceived benefits relative to perceived costs.

Exercise

Why is branding important?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 28: Sales Management

Lesson Content

Sales management plans, directs, and controls selling activities. It includes territory planning, prospecting, sales forecasting, performance management, and customer relationship development.

Exercise

List five functions of sales management.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 29: Customer Relationship Management

Lesson Content

CRM uses processes and technology to organize customer interactions, improve service, retain customers, and support sales and marketing decisions.

Exercise

Give five benefits of CRM.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 30: Human Resource Management

Lesson Content

HRM manages the employee lifecycle, including workforce planning, recruitment, selection, onboarding, development, performance, rewards, employee relations, and separation.

Exercise

List eight major HR functions.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 31: Recruitment and Selection

Lesson Content

Recruitment attracts qualified applicants; selection evaluates candidates against job requirements. Fair and structured processes improve the quality and consistency of hiring decisions.

Exercise

Differentiate recruitment and selection.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 32: Training and Development

Lesson Content

Training improves knowledge, skills, and capabilities for current roles, while development supports longer-term growth and career readiness.

Exercise

Why is employee training important?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 33: Performance Management

Lesson Content

Performance management aligns individual contributions with organizational objectives through expectations, feedback, evidence, development, and review.

Exercise

List five elements of effective performance management.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 34: Compensation and Benefits

Lesson Content

Compensation includes wages or salaries and may include incentives, allowances, benefits, and other rewards. Pay systems should consider fairness, legal requirements, market conditions, and organizational strategy.

Exercise

Differentiate direct and indirect compensation.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 35: Operations Management

Lesson Content

Operations management plans and controls processes that transform inputs into products or services. It focuses on quality, capacity, productivity, cost, delivery, and continuous improvement.

Exercise

Define operations management.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 36: Supply Chain Management

Lesson Content

Supply chain management coordinates sourcing, procurement, production, logistics, inventory, distribution, and information flows from suppliers to customers.

Exercise

List seven supply-chain activities.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 37: Inventory Management

Lesson Content

Inventory management balances availability and cost. Key concepts include stock levels, reorder points, lead time, safety stock, and inventory turnover.

Exercise

Why is inventory control important?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 38: Quality Management

Lesson Content

Quality management aims to consistently meet customer and applicable requirements. Approaches include quality planning, assurance, control, continuous improvement, and process management.

Exercise

Differentiate quality assurance and quality control.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 39: Financial Management for Managers

Lesson Content

Managers need basic knowledge of revenue, cost, cash flow, budgets, profitability, working capital, and investment decisions to make informed business choices.

Exercise

Why should non-accounting managers understand financial information?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 40: Budgeting and Budgetary Control

Lesson Content

Budgets convert plans into financial and operational targets. Budgetary control compares actual performance with plans and investigates significant variances.

Exercise

List five types of business budgets.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 41: Working Capital Management

Lesson Content

Working capital management concerns current assets and current liabilities, particularly cash, receivables, inventory, and payables. Good management supports liquidity without excessive idle resources.

Exercise

Name four major components of working capital.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 42: Business Law and Ethics

Lesson Content

Businesses operate within contracts, employment rules, consumer protections, corporate requirements, tax obligations, and other applicable laws. Ethical conduct extends beyond minimum legal compliance.

Exercise

Why should businesses distinguish legal compliance from ethical responsibility?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 43: Corporate Governance

Lesson Content

Corporate governance establishes structures and processes for direction, oversight, accountability, risk management, and responsible decision-making.

Exercise

List five principles associated with good corporate governance.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 44: Risk Management

Lesson Content

Risk management identifies, assesses, responds to, and monitors uncertainties that may affect objectives. Responses may include avoidance, reduction, transfer, or acceptance.

Exercise

Outline the risk-management process.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 45: Digital Business and E-Commerce

Lesson Content

Digital business uses information technology to create, deliver, market, and support value. E-commerce enables commercial transactions through electronic channels.

Exercise

List five advantages and three risks of e-commerce.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 46: Business Data and Information Systems

Lesson Content

Information systems transform data into useful information for operations, management, and strategic decisions. Managers should understand data quality, security, access, and interpretation.

Exercise

Differentiate data and information.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 47: Innovation and Change Management

Lesson Content

Organizations change because of technology, competition, regulation, customer expectations, crises, or strategic choices. Change management prepares people, processes, and systems for transition.

Exercise

List five reasons employees may resist change.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 48: Project Management

Lesson Content

Projects are temporary efforts with defined objectives, scope, resources, schedule, and deliverables. Project management coordinates initiation, planning, execution, monitoring, and closure.

Exercise

Name the main stages of a project lifecycle.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 49: Professionalism and Business Ethics

Lesson Content

Professionalism includes competence, reliability, respect, integrity, accountability, appropriate communication, confidentiality, and continuous learning.

Exercise

List eight qualities of a professional manager.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 50: Final Revision and Management Practice

Lesson Content

Business administration integrates strategy, people, marketing, operations, finance, technology, governance, and decision-making. Effective managers align resources with organizational objectives while managing risk and ethical responsibilities.

Exercise

Summarize the management process from organizational goals to measured results.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Final Assessment: 60 Questions and Answers

Attempt each question before reading the answer.

1. What is business administration?

Answer: The coordination and management of organizational resources, activities, and processes to achieve objectives.

2. What is management?

Answer: The process of planning, organizing, staffing, directing, and controlling resources to achieve objectives effectively and efficiently.

3. Name five management functions.

Answer: Planning, organizing, staffing, directing/leading, and controlling.

4. What is planning?

Answer: Determining objectives and deciding actions and resources needed to achieve them.

5. What is organizing?

Answer: Arranging tasks, people, authority, and resources into a coordinated structure.

6. What is staffing?

Answer: Acquiring, developing, deploying, and maintaining the people needed by an organization.

7. What is controlling?

Answer: Measuring performance against plans, identifying deviations, and taking appropriate corrective action.

8. What is a business environment?

Answer: The internal and external conditions that influence an organization's operations and performance.

9. Name six external environmental factors.

Answer: Political, economic, social, technological, legal, competitive, and environmental factors.

10. What is entrepreneurship?

Answer: The process of identifying opportunities, organizing resources, innovating, and creating value through a venture or initiative.

11. What is a business plan?

Answer: A structured document describing a business's objectives, market, operations, strategy, management, finances, and risks.

12. What is organizational structure?

Answer: The formal arrangement of roles, authority, reporting relationships, and coordination.

13. What is organizational culture?

Answer: Shared values, beliefs, norms, and practices that influence behavior within an organization.

14. What is leadership?

Answer: The process of influencing and enabling people to work toward shared objectives.

15. What is the difference between leadership and management?

Answer: Management emphasizes coordination and execution of plans; leadership emphasizes influence, direction, and mobilization of people. They overlap in practice.

16. What is motivation?

Answer: The set of factors that influence the direction, intensity, and persistence of effort toward goals.

17. Name five non-financial motivators.

Answer: Recognition, meaningful work, development, autonomy, participation, feedback, and supportive working conditions.

18. What is teamwork?

Answer: Coordinated effort by people with complementary roles and skills toward a shared objective.

19. Name five communication barriers.

Answer: Noise, unclear language, poor listening, information overload, assumptions, cultural differences, and inappropriate channels.

20. What is decision-making?

Answer: Selecting a course of action from alternatives based on objectives, information, judgment, and constraints.

21. What is problem solving?

Answer: A structured process for identifying problems, finding causes, developing solutions, implementing them, and evaluating results.

22. What is strategic management?

Answer: The process of formulating, implementing, and evaluating strategies to achieve long-term organizational objectives.

23. What is a mission statement?

Answer: A statement describing an organization's fundamental purpose.

24. What is a vision statement?

Answer: A statement describing the desired future state of an organization.

25. What is SWOT analysis?

Answer: Analysis of strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats.

26. What is PESTLE analysis?

Answer: Analysis of political, economic, social, technological, legal, and environmental factors.

27. What is marketing?

Answer: The process of creating, communicating, delivering, and exchanging value to meet customer and organizational needs.

28. What is market research?

Answer: Systematic collection and analysis of information about customers, competitors, markets, and trends.

29. What is market segmentation?

Answer: Dividing a market into meaningful groups with similar characteristics or needs.

30. What are the 4Ps?

Answer: Product, Price, Place, and Promotion.

31. What is branding?

Answer: The creation and management of an identity and set of associations linked to an offering or organization.

32. What is sales management?

Answer: Planning, directing, and controlling activities involved in selling products or services.

33. What is CRM?

Answer: Customer Relationship Management: processes and systems for managing customer interactions and relationships.

34. What is human resource management?

Answer: Management of people throughout the employment lifecycle to support organizational and employee objectives.

35. Differentiate recruitment and selection.

Answer: Recruitment attracts applicants; selection evaluates and chooses suitable candidates.

36. What is employee training?

Answer: A structured process for improving knowledge, skills, and capabilities relevant to work.

37. What is performance management?

Answer: A continuous process of setting expectations, monitoring results, providing feedback, and developing performance.

38. What is compensation?

Answer: Financial and non-financial rewards provided in exchange for work.

39. What is operations management?

Answer: Planning and controlling processes that transform inputs into products or services.

40. What is supply chain management?

Answer: Coordination of sourcing, procurement, production, logistics, inventory, distribution, and related information flows.

41. Why is inventory control important?

Answer: It balances product availability with carrying costs, shortages, waste, and working-capital requirements.

42. What is quality assurance?

Answer: Planned activities that provide confidence that processes and systems can consistently meet requirements.

43. What is quality control?

Answer: Operational activities used to inspect, measure, test, and verify that outputs meet requirements.

44. Why should managers understand finance?

Answer: Financial information supports budgeting, resource allocation, profitability analysis, cash management, and decision-making.

45. What is a budget?

Answer: A quantified plan for a future period.

46. What is working capital?

Answer: Current assets minus current liabilities; it is closely associated with short-term operating liquidity.

47. What is corporate governance?

Answer: Structures and processes for directing, overseeing, controlling, and holding an organization accountable.

48. What is risk management?

Answer: Identifying, assessing, responding to, and monitoring risks that may affect objectives.

49. What is e-commerce?

Answer: Commercial activity conducted through electronic or digital channels.

50. What is the difference between data and information?

Answer: Data are raw facts or observations; information is processed and interpreted data that has useful meaning.

51. What is change management?

Answer: A structured approach to preparing, supporting, and guiding people and processes through organizational change.

52. What is a project?

Answer: A temporary effort undertaken to create a defined product, service, or result.

53. What is professionalism?

Answer: Consistent demonstration of competence, integrity, responsibility, respect, and appropriate conduct.

54. Why is business ethics important?

Answer: Ethical behavior supports trust, responsible decisions, reputation, stakeholder relationships, and sustainable performance.

55. What is delegation?

Answer: Assigning responsibility and appropriate authority to another person while retaining overall accountability.

56. What is span of control?

Answer: The number of people who report directly to a manager.

57. What is organizational efficiency?

Answer: Using resources with minimal avoidable waste to achieve desired outputs.

58. What is organizational effectiveness?

Answer: The degree to which an organization achieves its intended objectives.

Practical Exercises

Exercise 1 — Business Environment Analysis

Choose a small business and analyze its internal strengths and weaknesses and external opportunities and threats using SWOT.

Exercise 2 — Business Plan

Develop a concise business plan for a realistic venture. Include the problem, target market, value proposition, marketing strategy, operations, management, risks, and basic financial assumptions.

Exercise 3 — Marketing Plan

Create a 4Ps marketing plan for a product or service. Define the target customer, positioning, price approach, distribution channel, and promotional activities.

Exercise 4 — HR Plan

Prepare a simple recruitment, onboarding, training, and performance-management plan for three new employees.

Exercise 5 — Management Case Study

Analyze a fictional business experiencing declining sales, staff turnover, and rising costs. Identify root causes, propose actions, assign responsibilities, and define performance measures.

Business Administration & Management Glossary

Administration: Coordination and management of organizational activities and resources.

Management: Process of planning, organizing, staffing, directing, and controlling.

Planning: Setting objectives and determining actions and resources.

Organizing: Arranging tasks, people, authority, and resources.

Leadership: Influencing people toward shared objectives.

Motivation: Factors influencing effort toward goals.

Entrepreneurship: Identifying opportunities and creating value through a venture or initiative.

Business plan: Structured plan describing objectives, market, operations, strategy, finances, and risks.

Organization: A coordinated group of people and resources pursuing objectives.

Culture: Shared values, beliefs, norms, and practices in an organization.

SWOT: Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats.

PESTLE: Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental analysis.

Marketing: Creating and communicating value to meet customer and organizational needs.

Segmentation: Dividing a market into meaningful customer groups.

Brand: Identity and associations connected with an offering or organization.

CRM: Customer Relationship Management.

HRM: Human Resource Management.

Recruitment: Process of attracting potential employees.

Selection: Process of evaluating and choosing candidates.

Operations: Processes that transform inputs into products or services.

Supply chain: Network and processes involved in sourcing, production, logistics, and distribution.

Inventory: Stock held for production, sale, or operations.

Budget: Quantified plan for a future period.

Governance: Structures and processes for direction, oversight, and accountability.

Risk: Uncertainty that can affect objectives.

E-commerce: Commercial activity through electronic channels.

Information system: System that collects, processes, stores, and communicates information.

Project: Temporary effort with defined objectives and deliverables.

Professionalism: Competent, ethical, responsible, and appropriate conduct.

End of School of Business Studies — Business Administration & Management

Effective management combines strategy, people, processes, information, finance, technology, communication, governance, and ethical judgment. Managers should adapt methods to organizational context and applicable laws and standards.